



NO. 03 · AUTUMN 2025

VOID DISPATCH

Void Dispatch is a zine about cities, infrastructure, and the systems we live inside. Free to read. Free to print. Free to leave somewhere.

Contributing writers: Dana Ferris, M. Okafor, T. Nakamura, S. Reyes, P. Voss.

Printed on whatever you have.

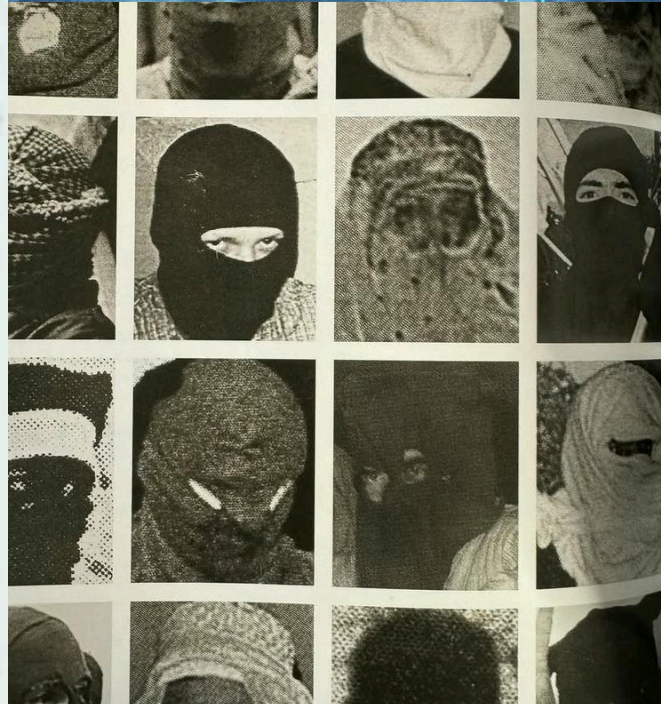
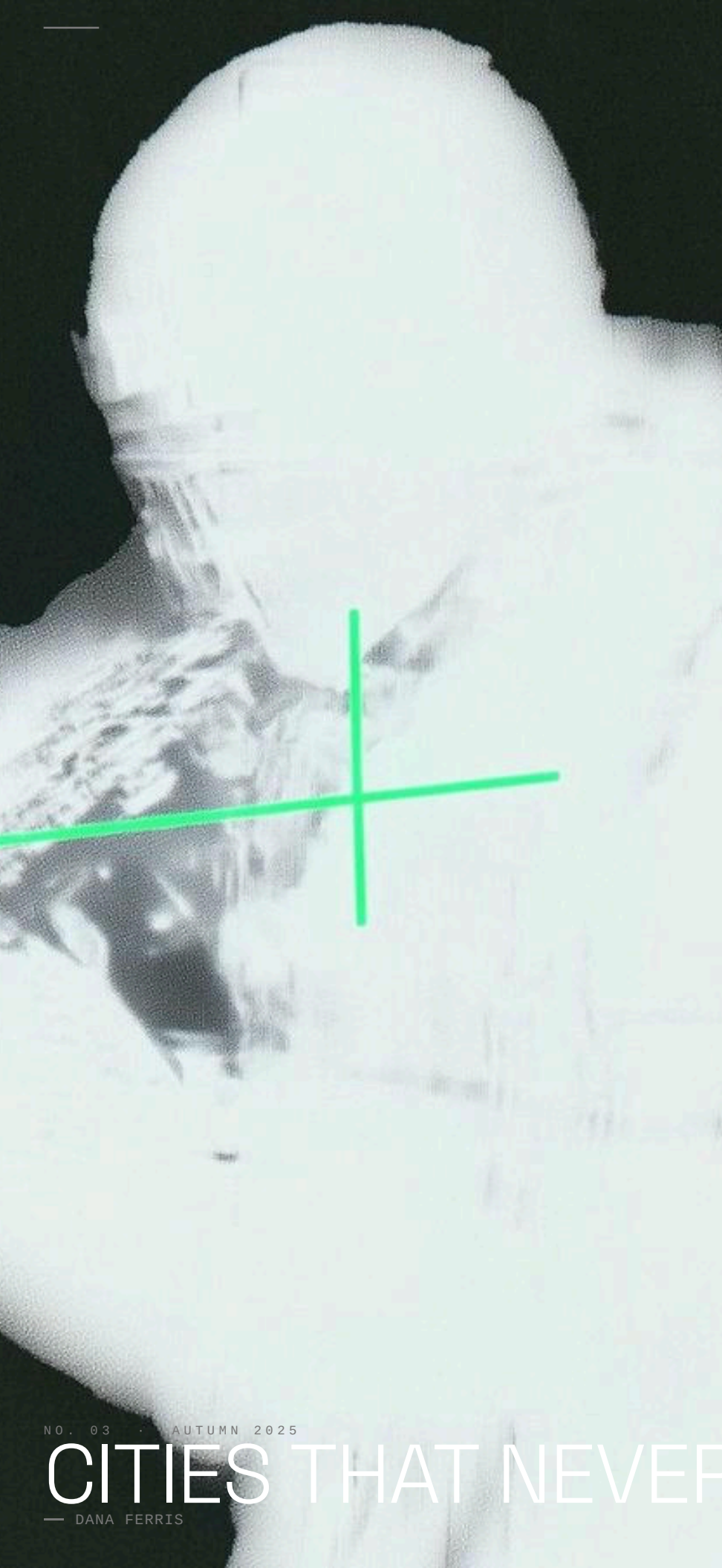
void-dispatch @ proton.me



NO. 03 · AUTUMN 2025

VOID DISPATCH

- 1 _____ CITIES THAT NEVER SLEEP
 - 2 _____ THREE WAYS TO DISAPPEAR
 - 3 _____ THE LAST PAYPHONE
 - 4 _____ SMALL GRID THEORY
 - 5 _____ THE MAINTENANCE WORKERS
 - 6 _____ THE SIGNAL LAYER
-



NO. 03 · AUTUMN 2025

CITIES THAT NEVER SLEEP

— DANA FERRIS

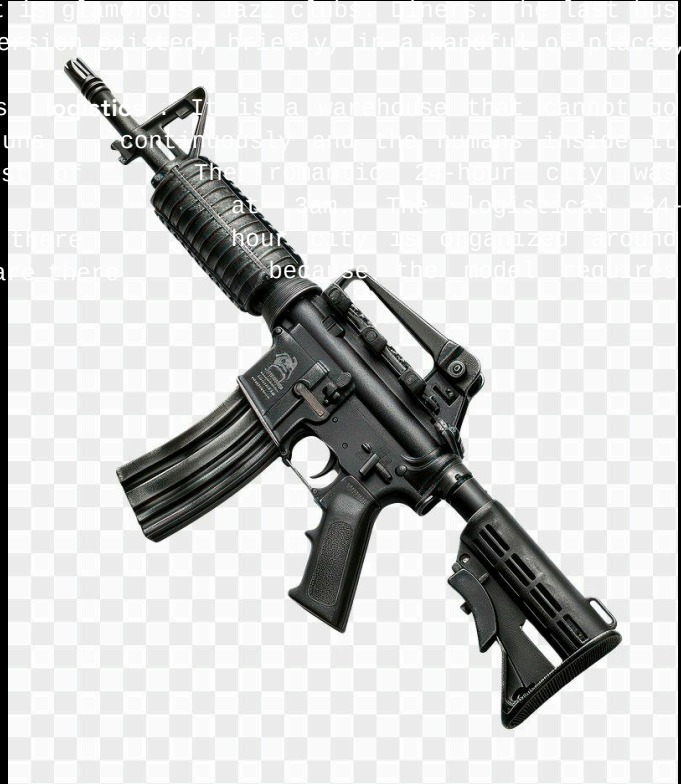
ARTICLE CITIES THAT NEVER SLEEP

— DANA FERRIS

There is a version of the 24-hour city that
home and someone interesting on it. That ve
and it was good.

The version we have now is different. It is dark because the sortation algorithm are cheaper than the reconfiguration cost of stopping.

organized around desire. Someone wanted to be
throughput. No one wants to be there. They a
it.



Q U O T E

"/ "FULFILLMENT CENTER, OUTER RING ROAD

The lights are always on here. That used to mean something.

— OUTSIDE A FULFILLMENT CENTER, 3:14AM



A city that cannot sleep is not
awake. It is running a process.



NOVEMBER 2025

THREE WAYS TO DISAPPEAR

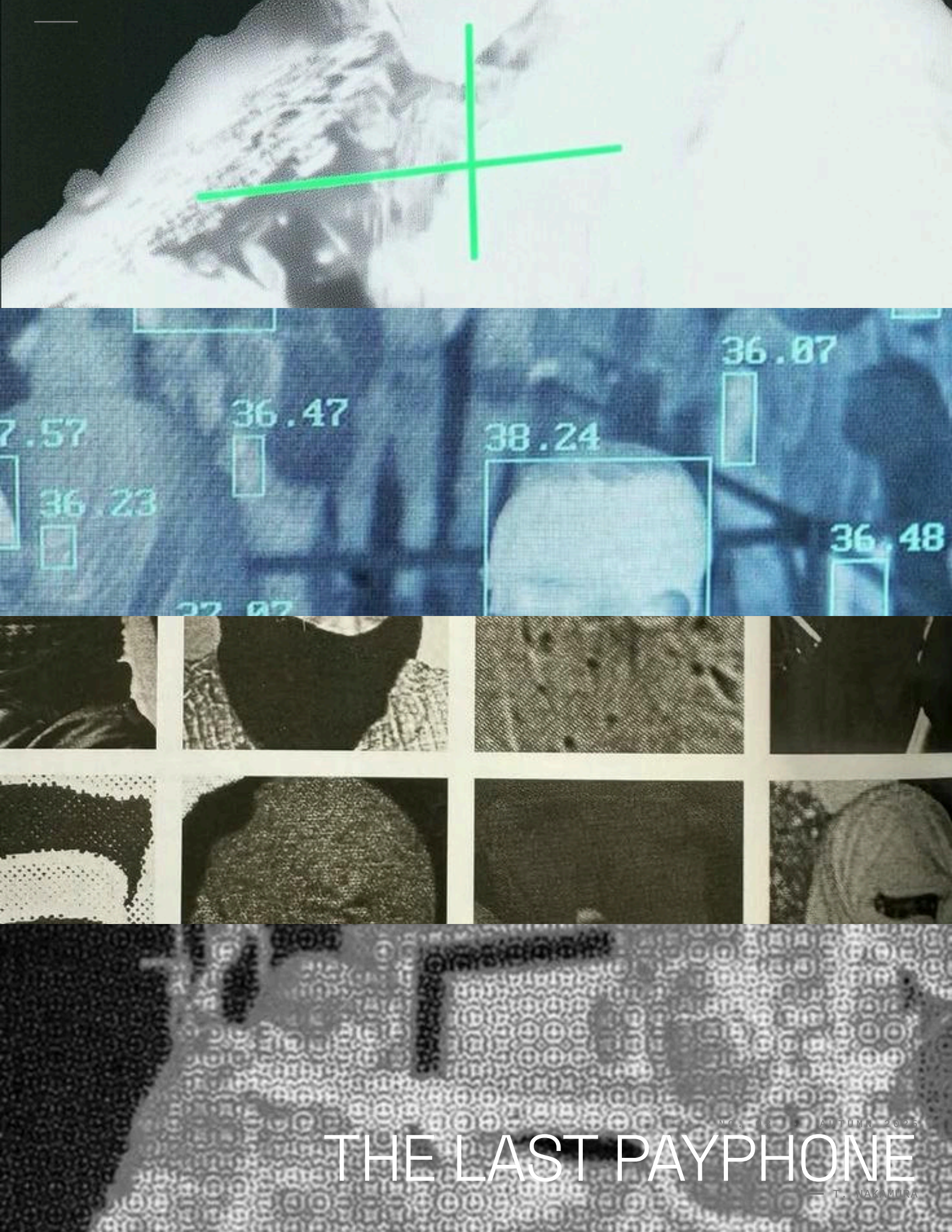
A photograph of two soldiers in full tactical gear, including helmets, goggles, and vests. They are both holding assault rifles. The soldier in the foreground is kneeling, while the one behind is standing and aiming. The image is set against a transparent background with a faint watermark.

Method three: make boring choices visible. Notice when you every choice requires a different decision. But many someone whose interests are not yours. Default tracking, personalized ads. Reversing these — no deliberately — changes what flows through the pipes.

Most surveillance is passive and opportunistic. It flows through the pipes. A notebook does not have policy. A pocket calendar does not sync to a data center, personal notes, appointments with people you know, and a network.



You are probably not being targeted specifically. You are in a database being queried by systems with no opinion about you as a person. The goal is not to escape the database. The goal is to make the query less useful.



THE LAST PAYPHONE

MAY 2005 AUTUMN 2005

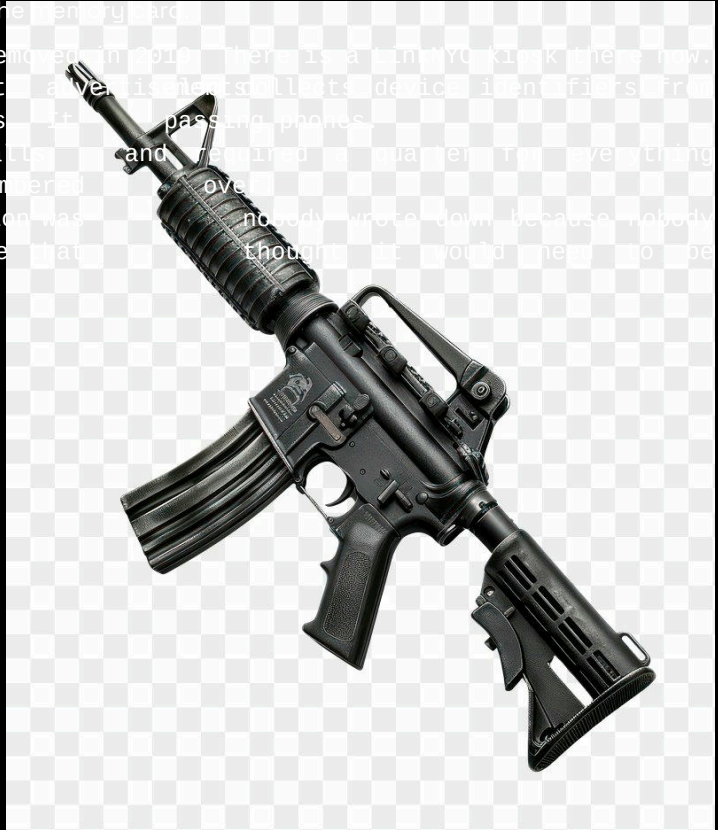
— T. NAKAMURA

THE LAST PAYPHONE

— T. NAKAMURA

A photo essay without photos, because we lost the memory card.

The payphone on Delancey and Essex was removed in 2011. There is a tiny kiosk there now. The kiosk offers free calls, fast advertisements, collects device identifiers from passing phones, and a screen that displays the faces of passing phones. The payphone offered free emergency calls and required no money for anything else. It collected nothing. It remembered everything. When you hung up, the conversation was never written down, because nobody did. This was not a bug. This was a feature that nobody thought would need to be defended.

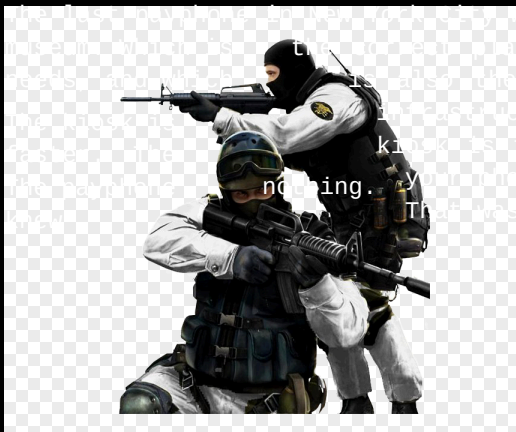


QUOTE

"/ "DELANCEY AND ESSEX, 2019

You could call anyone and they couldn't call you back unless they already knew where you were.

— A PERSON WHO REMEMBERED THE QUARTER



The payphone was removed from a hotel lobby in 2022. It is now in a kiosk that is the correct place for things that society has decided it no longer needs. It is the correct place to go to feel the specific grief of future loss. The kiosk is free. The kiosk is always available. The kiosk knows nothing. You were near it at 11:47am on a Tuesday in March. That was the whole point.



NO. 06 · AUTUMN 25

SMALL GRID THEORY

— S. REYES

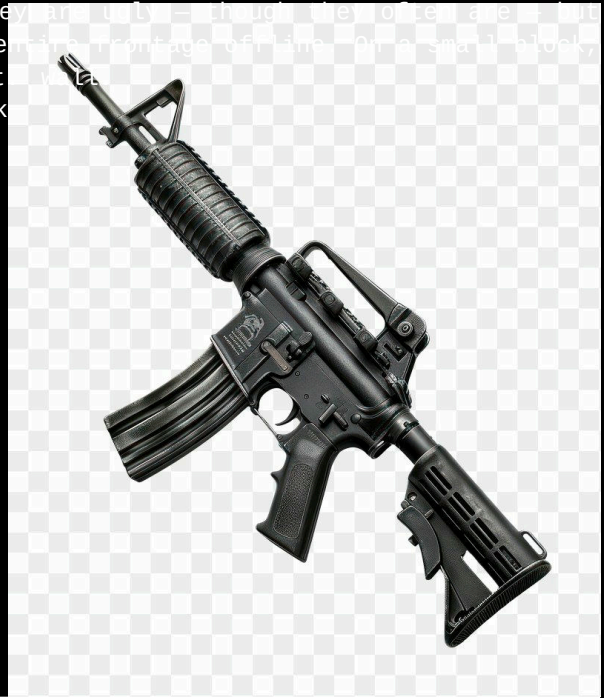
SMALL GRID THEORY

— S. REYES



It is still able to hold its own in most cities share one physical characteristic that urban areas consistently undervalue: **small blocks**. Not "small" in the sense of having sidewalks. Not "small" in the sense of having a Starbucks on the ground floor of a condo tower. Small blocks. Short distances between intersections. Many choices of route. The reason small blocks win is not aesthetic. It is because small blocks offers exponentially more route choices than large blocks. More route choices means more foot traffic distributed across more paths means more storefronts viable

Large blocks produce dead zones. Not because they are too big, but because a single failed anchor tenant takes an entire block. On a superblock, it is four hundred feet of blank



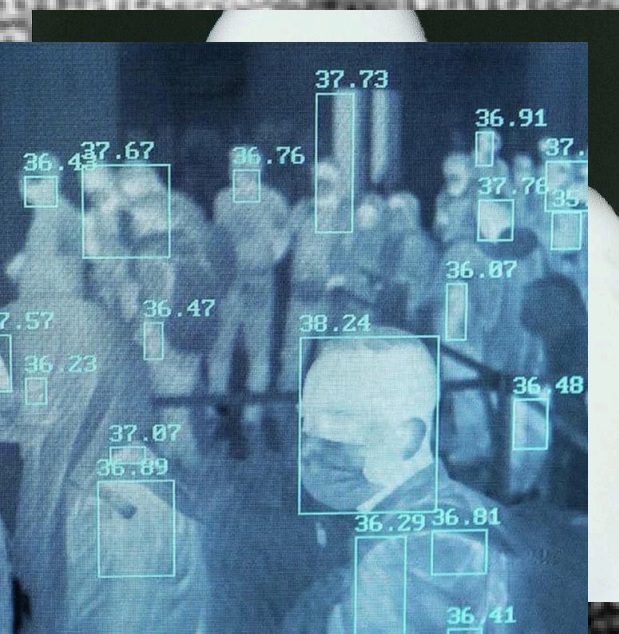
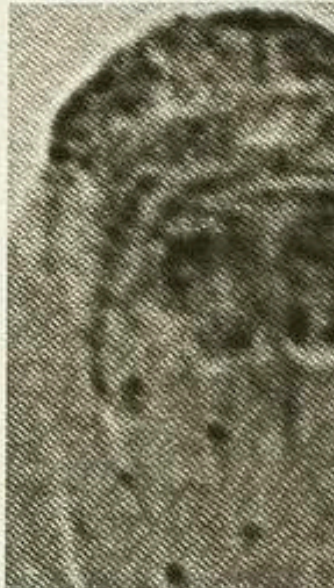
Density is not the variable. Granularity is the variable.



large-block grid by adding mixed-use zoning. You can

add a coffee shop on the ground floor of a 700-foot-frontage building and it will feel like a coffee shop in an airport. Because it is.

The blocks have to be small first. Everything else follows from the blocks. Jane Jacobs said this in 1961. We have spent sixty years building the opposite.



TENANCE WORKERS

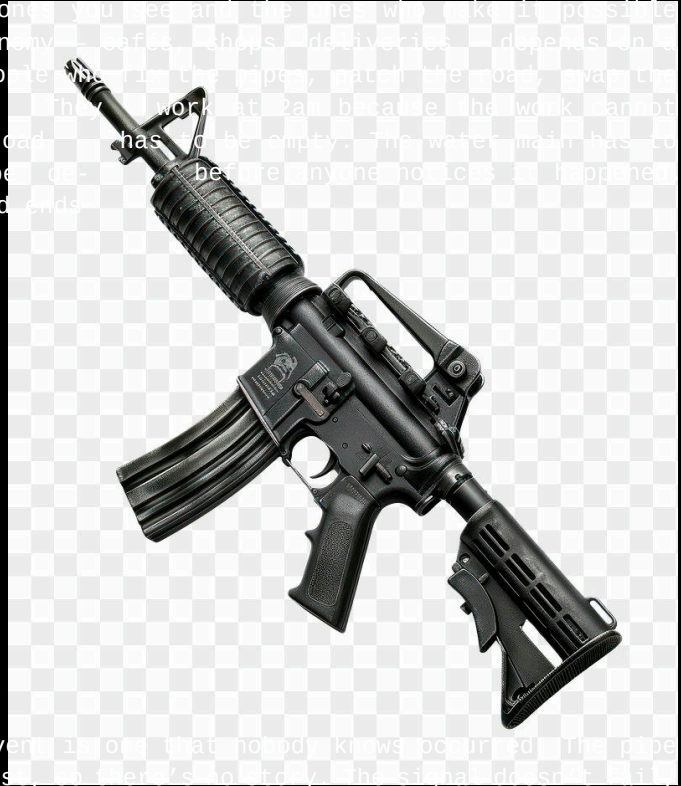
NO. 03 • AUTUMN 2025

— 038

THE MAINTENANCE WORKERS

— P. VOSS

Every city has two kinds of workers. The one you see and the one who make it possible for you to see them. The street-level economy of cafes, shops, deliveries, deliveries on a substrate that is mostly invisible: the people who fix the pipe, at the road, wait the transformer, re-hang the signal. They work at 2am because the work can only happen when the city is using itself. The road has to be empty. The water main has to be isolated. The substation has to be cut off before anyone notices. It happens energized. The shift starts at midnight and ends

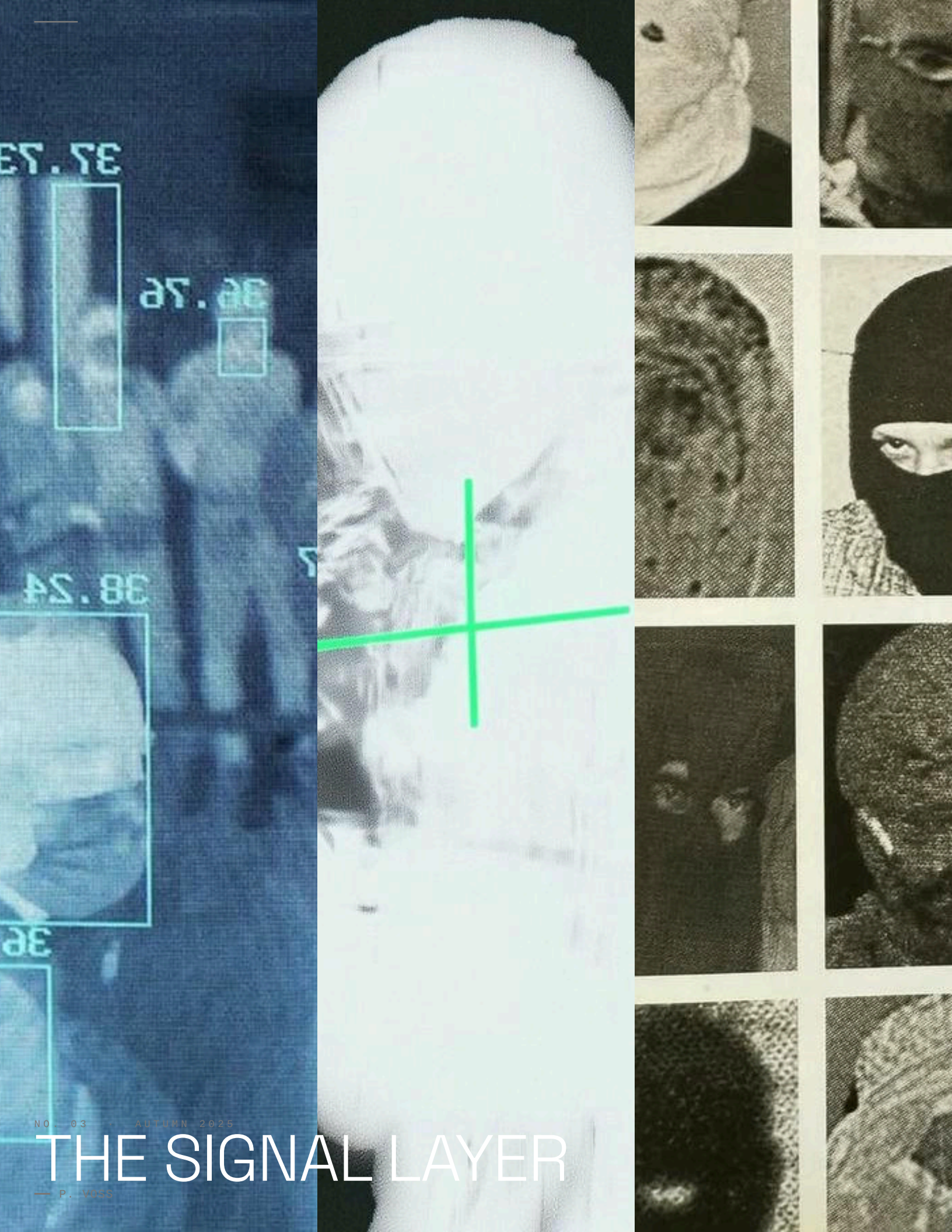


INVISIBILITY AS SUCCESS METRIC

The KPI for infrastructure maintenance is the absence of events. Nothing happened. That is the goal. That is how you know it worked.

We have built an economy around visibility — money, then we have built the physical world on top of it. We think about them at all.





NO 03 · AUTUMN 2025

THE SIGNAL LAYER

— P. VOSS

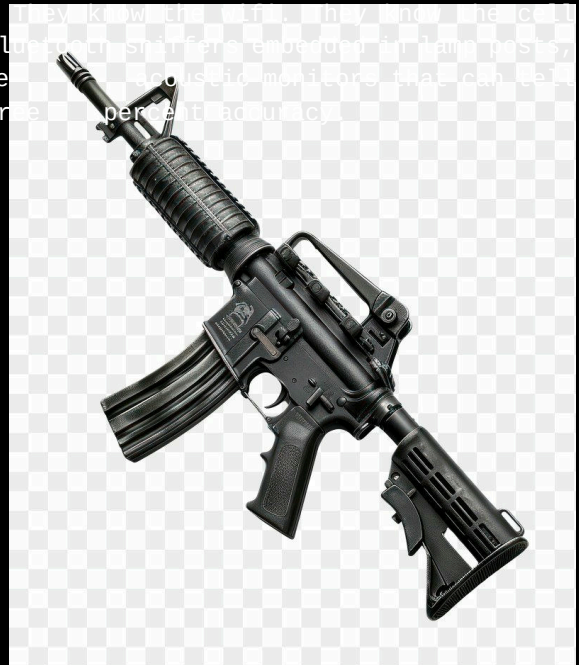
THE SIGNAL LAYER

— P. VOSS



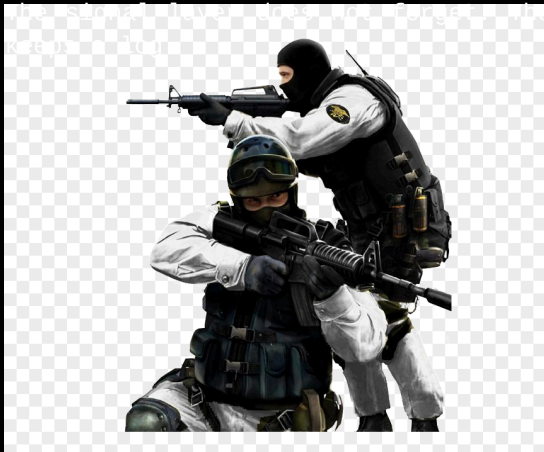
Even if you dig to a layer of concrete, you can't see the pipes, not the wires – those are findable, orange, orange-flagged before you dig. The signal layer is different. It is the mesh of transmissions that tells the traffic light what the car did three blocks away, that tells the transit authority the bus is running four minutes late, that tells the logistics platform the driver has stalled. With our city, the signal layer is where the city becomes legible to the world. Buses are just buses. With it, the buses are a dataset. The cars are just cars. With it, the cars are a dataset. The pedestrians are a dataset. The city reads itself continuously, and the reading changes what it does.

Most people do not know the signal layer exists. They do not know the mesh, the LIDAR, the Bluebird sensors embedded in the road, the license plate readers every four blocks, the gunshot from a car backfire with ninety-three

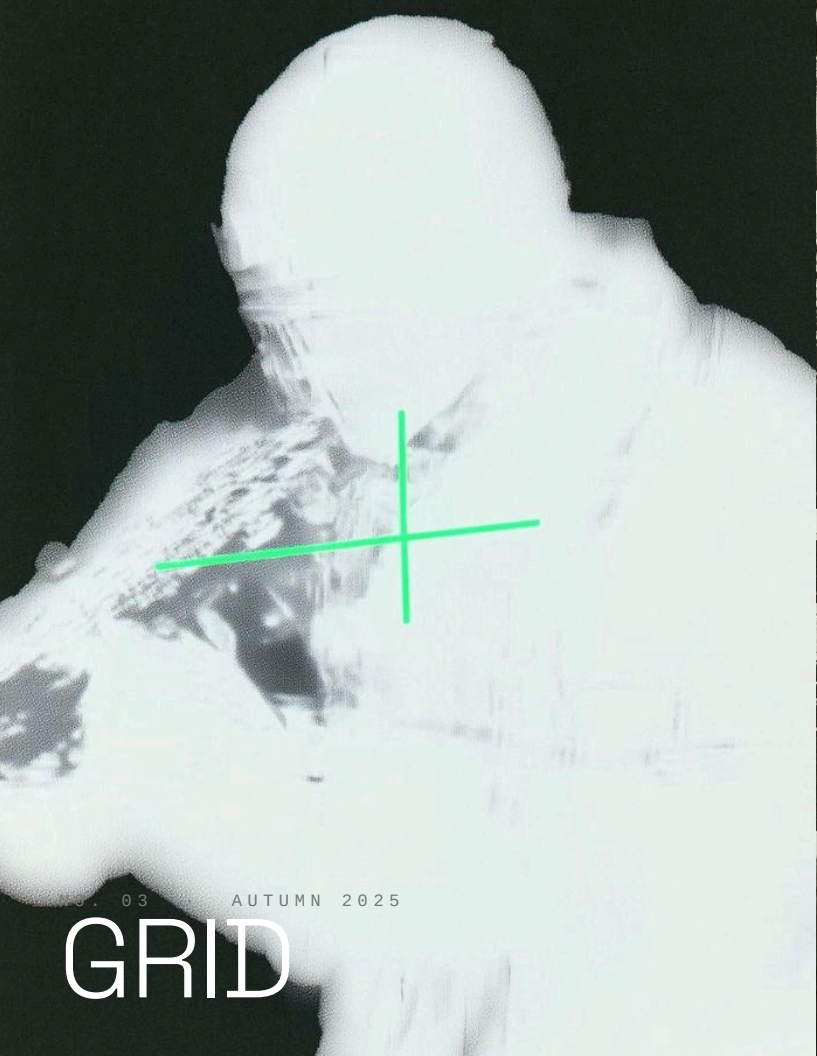


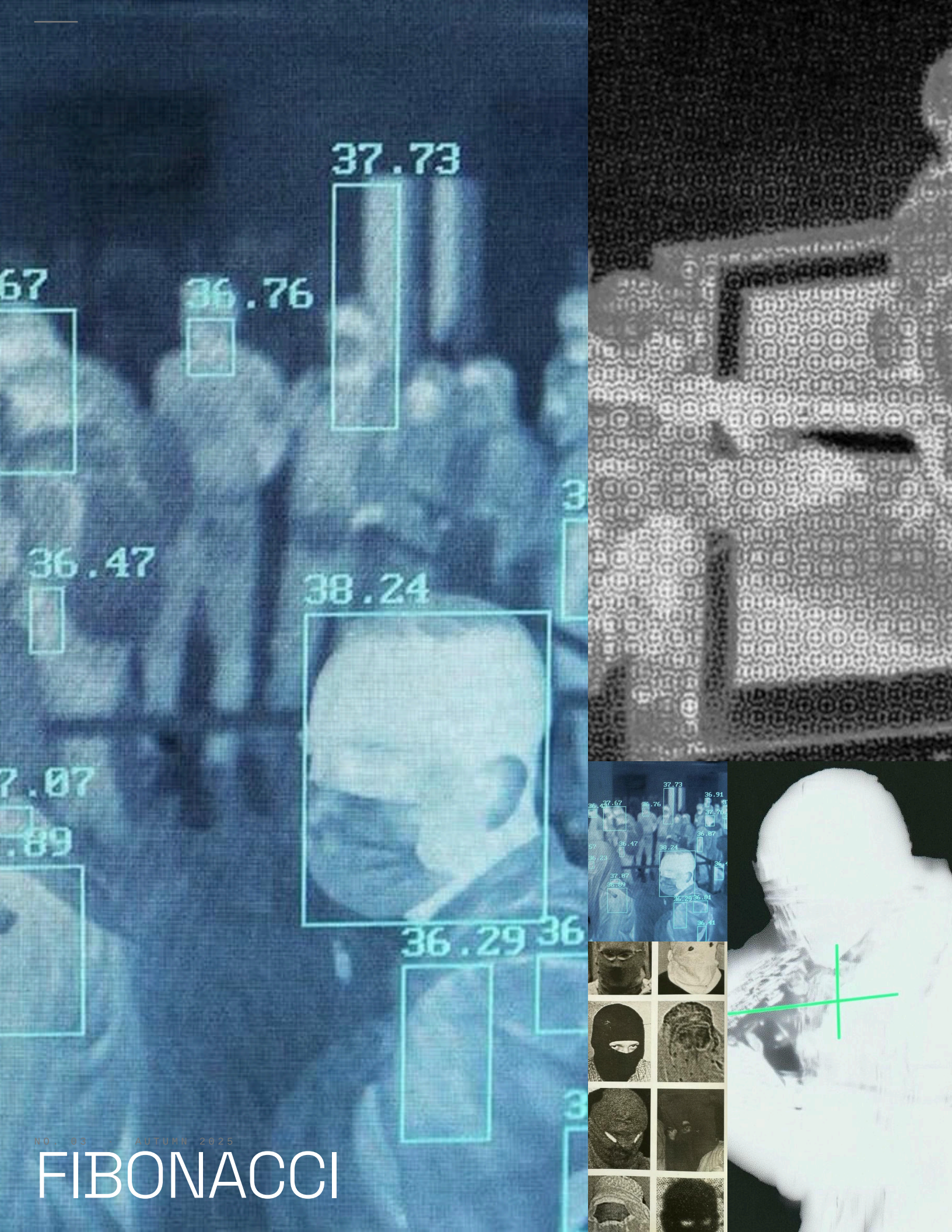
WHAT THE SIGNAL LAYER KNOWS

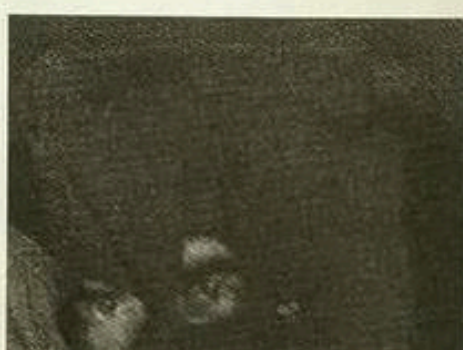
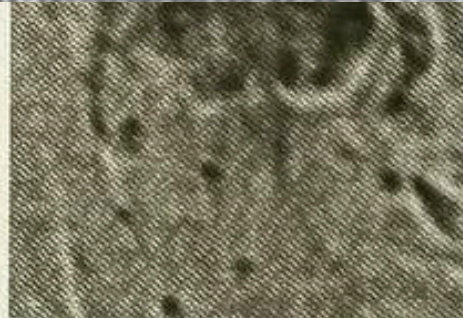
Where you were. How fast you moved. What device you carried. Whether you stopped. For how long. Whether you stopped at that spot before.



The buses forget. The people forget. The signal layer

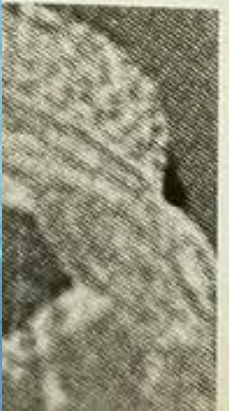
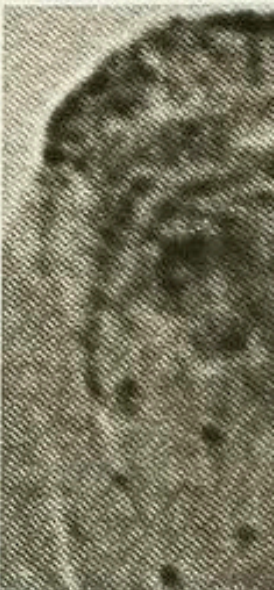
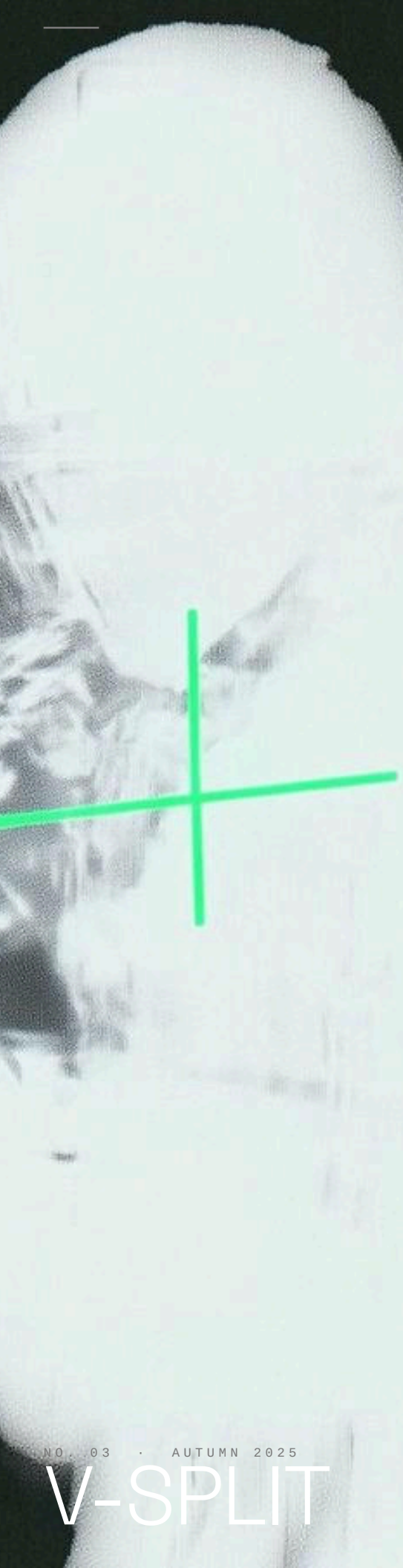


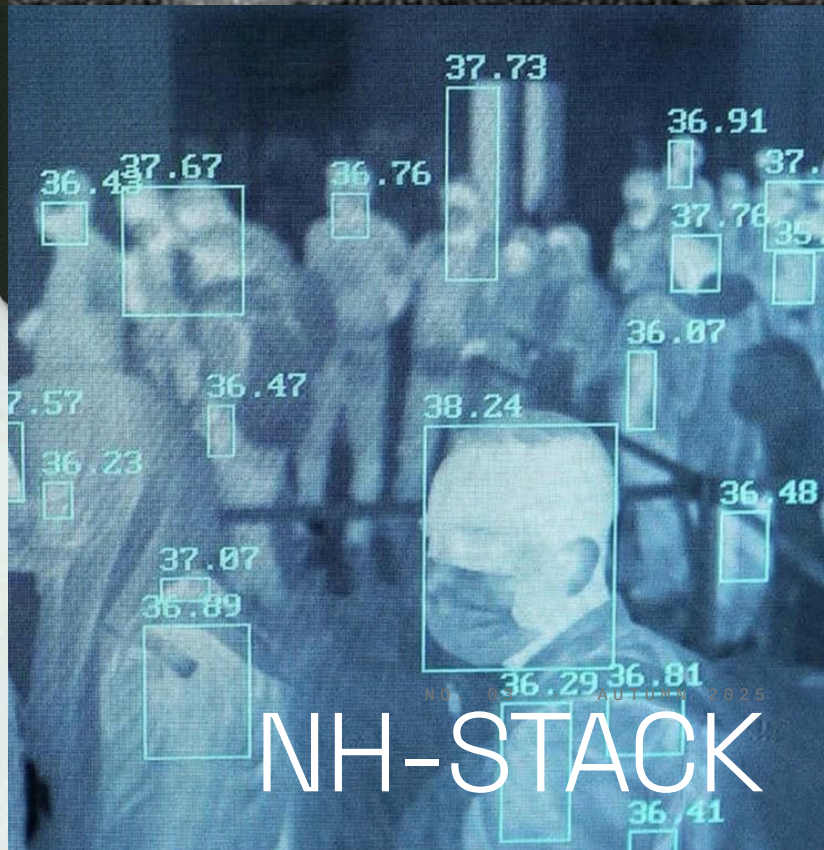
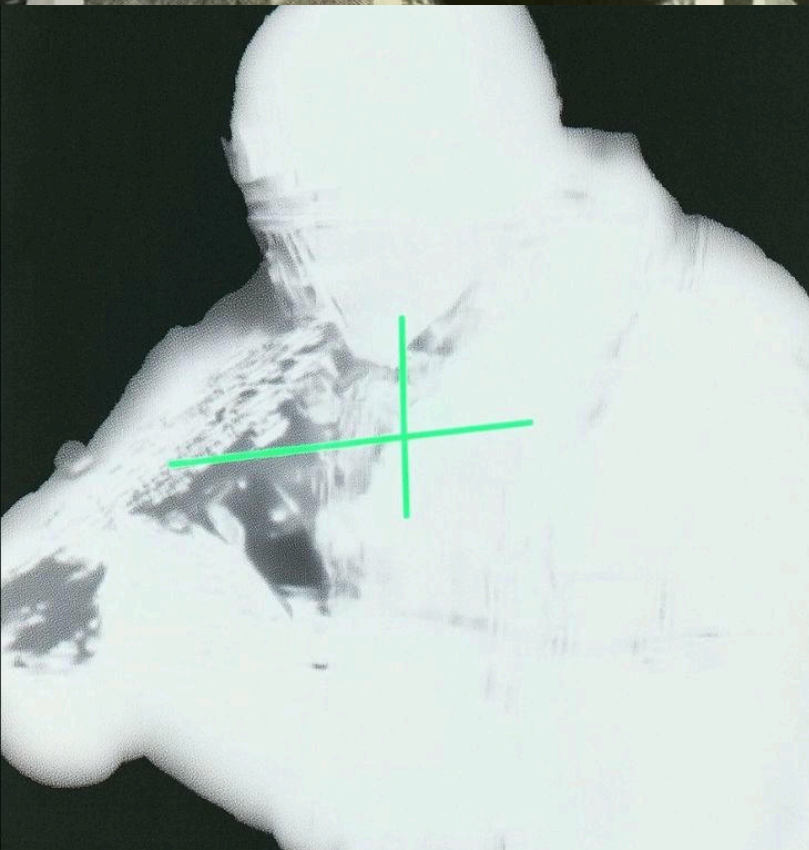
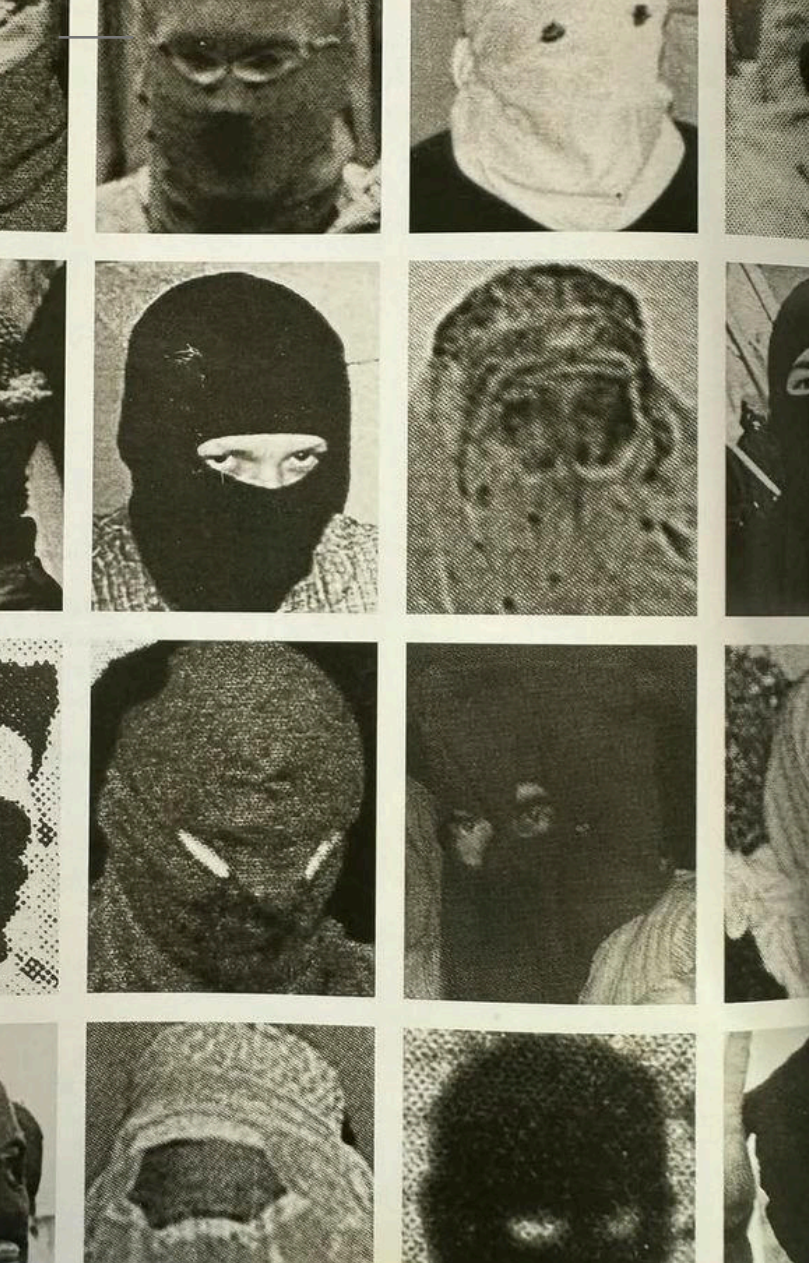


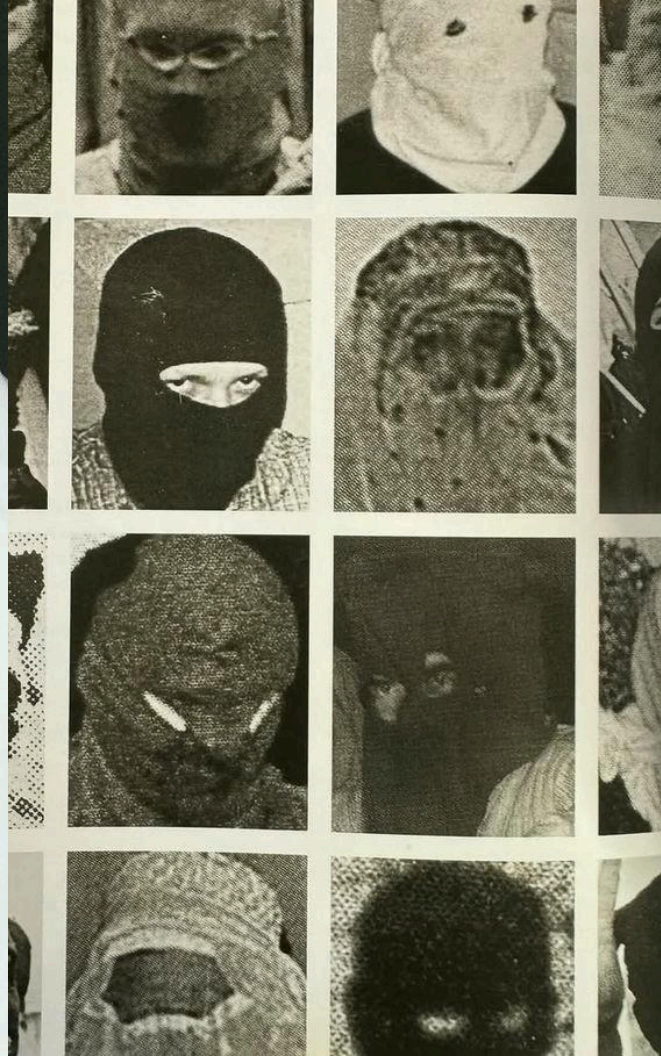


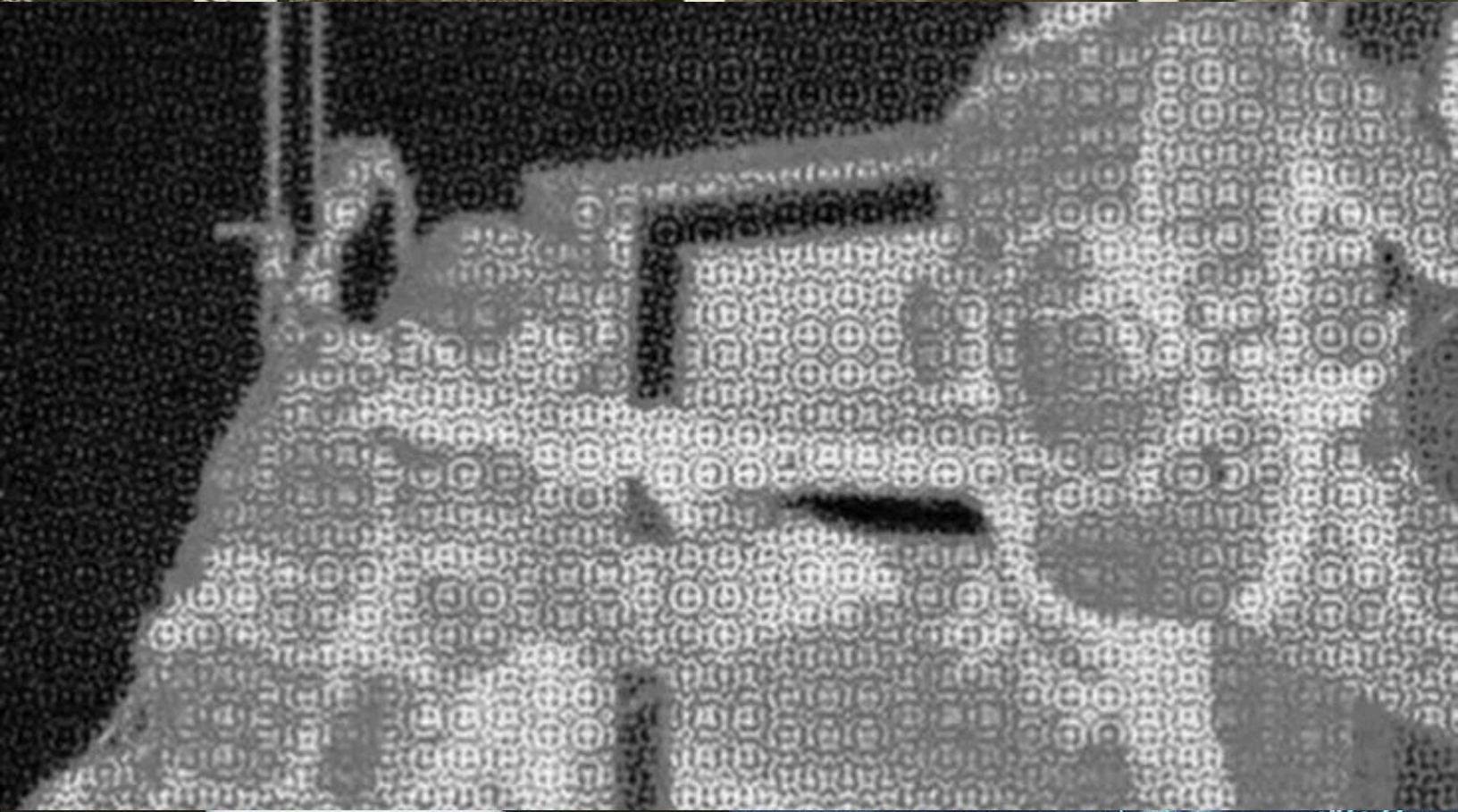
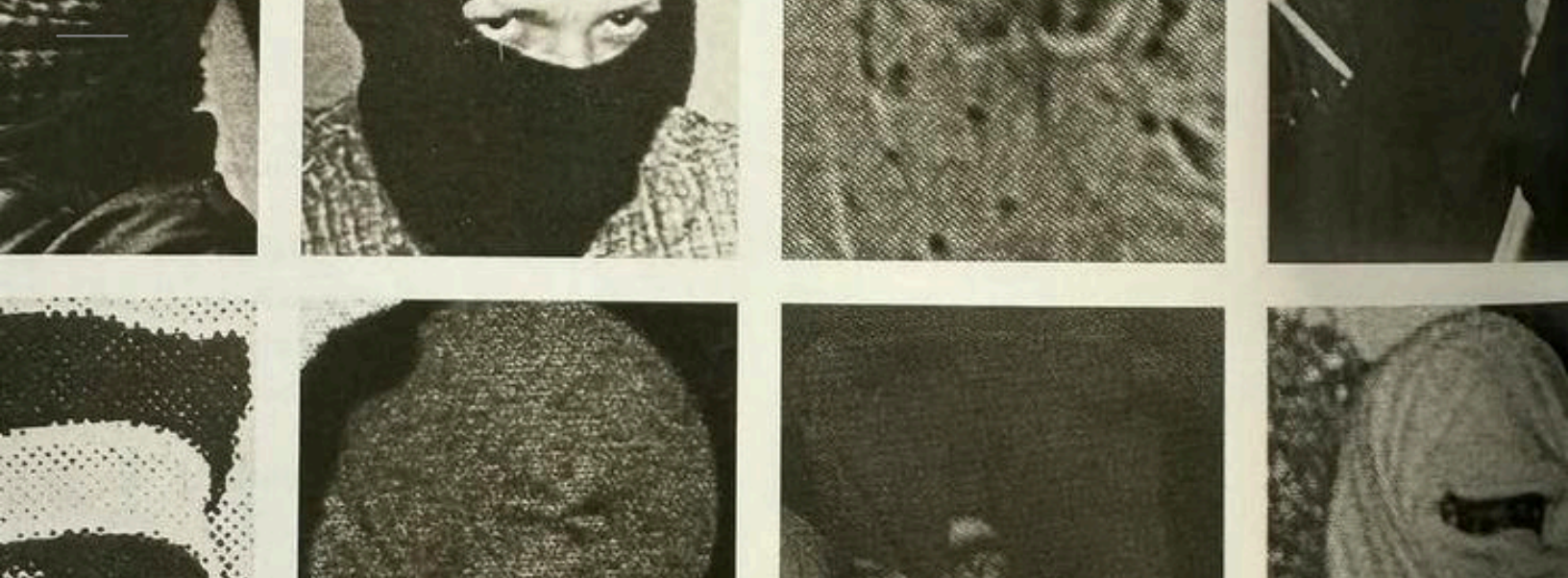
NO. 03 AUTUMN 2022

H-SPLIT



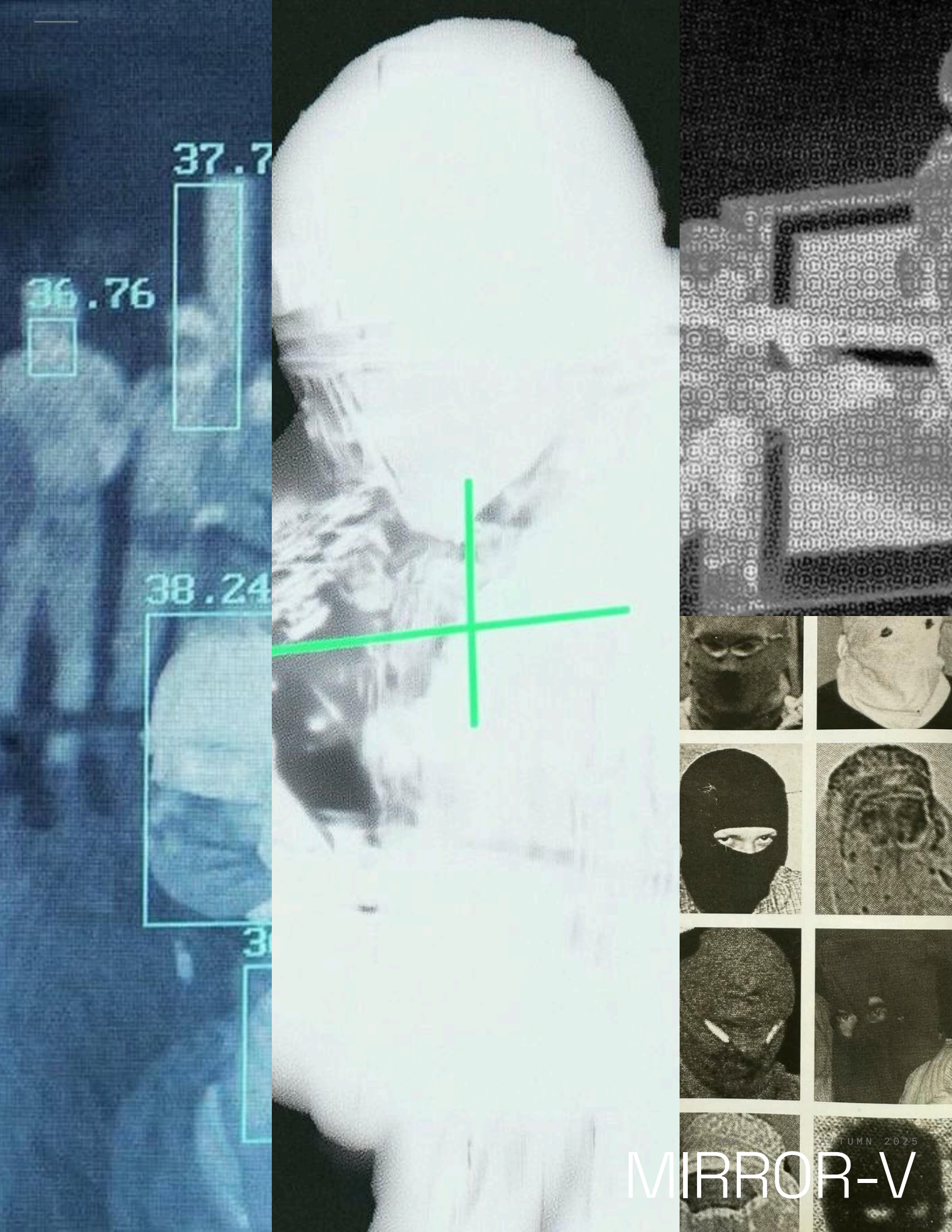






NO 03 · AUTUMN 2025

MIRROR-H



36.76

37.7

38.24

3

MIRROR-V

FALL 2025

ON THE BUS PIECE (ISSUE 02) ____

You said the bus is slow because of choices, not physics. I've been thinking about this for three weeks. You're right and I hate it. — **J.W., Chicago**

CORRECTION ____

The Houston light rail does not go to the airport. We stated that it did. It does not. We regret this. — **the editors**

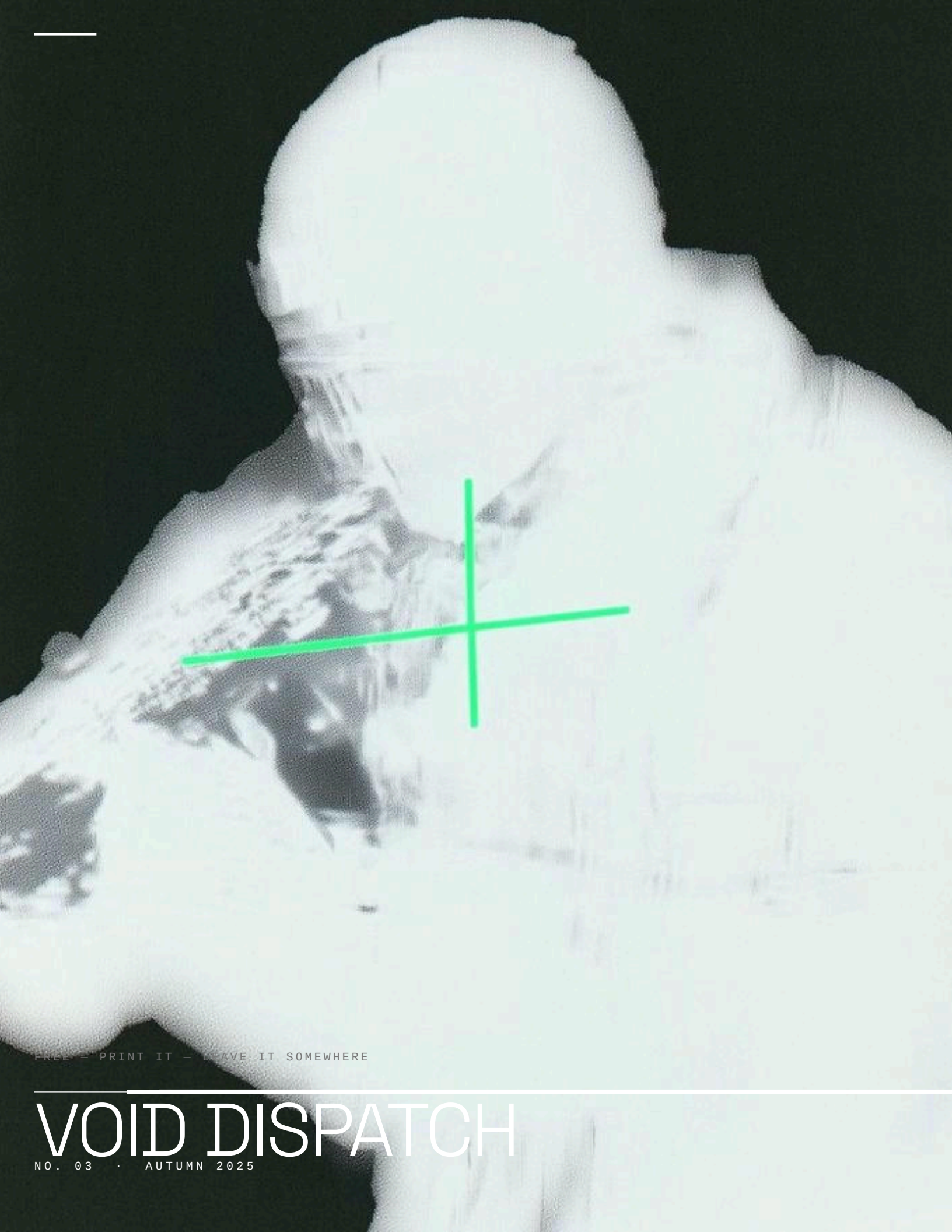
SUBMISSIONS ____

800 words or fewer. No pitches. Send it done. Plaintext. — **void-dispatch@proton.me**

Next issue: infrastructure that fights back. Submissions open. 800 words or fewer. No pitches. Send it done.

void-dispatch @ proton.me





FREE — PRINT IT — LEAVE IT SOMEWHERE

VOID DISPATCH

NO. 03 · AUTUMN 2025

